

21st Century Learning Environments

A Highly Innovative Skills-Based Curriculum
combined with Entrepreneurial Incubators
Known As **METALABS**



META24

A 21ST CENTURY LEARNING CENTER



META24
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META24™

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www.meta24.org

Make It

Enterprise It

Teach It

Achieve It

A 21st Century Learning
Environment.

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What is META24?

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A **META24** learning center is a place where students not only learn essential skills and earn credits, but where they also proactively prepare for successful futures.

ENVISION

Imagine a state-of-the-art learning center combining an innovative skills-based curriculum - the Inquiry Bridge Learning System - with individual entrepreneurial incubators known as **METALABS**.

Engaged in the Inquiry Bridge Learning System, students master skills through an inquiry-based curriculum designed for metacognitive growth. Their progress is documented on a success board which allows for individual pacing.

The focus of individual **METALABS** is on highly relevant and culturally meaningful content and career areas including hi-tech, industrial engineering and fashion design through the process of synthesizing real projects and mastering skills in an entrepreneurial learning space.

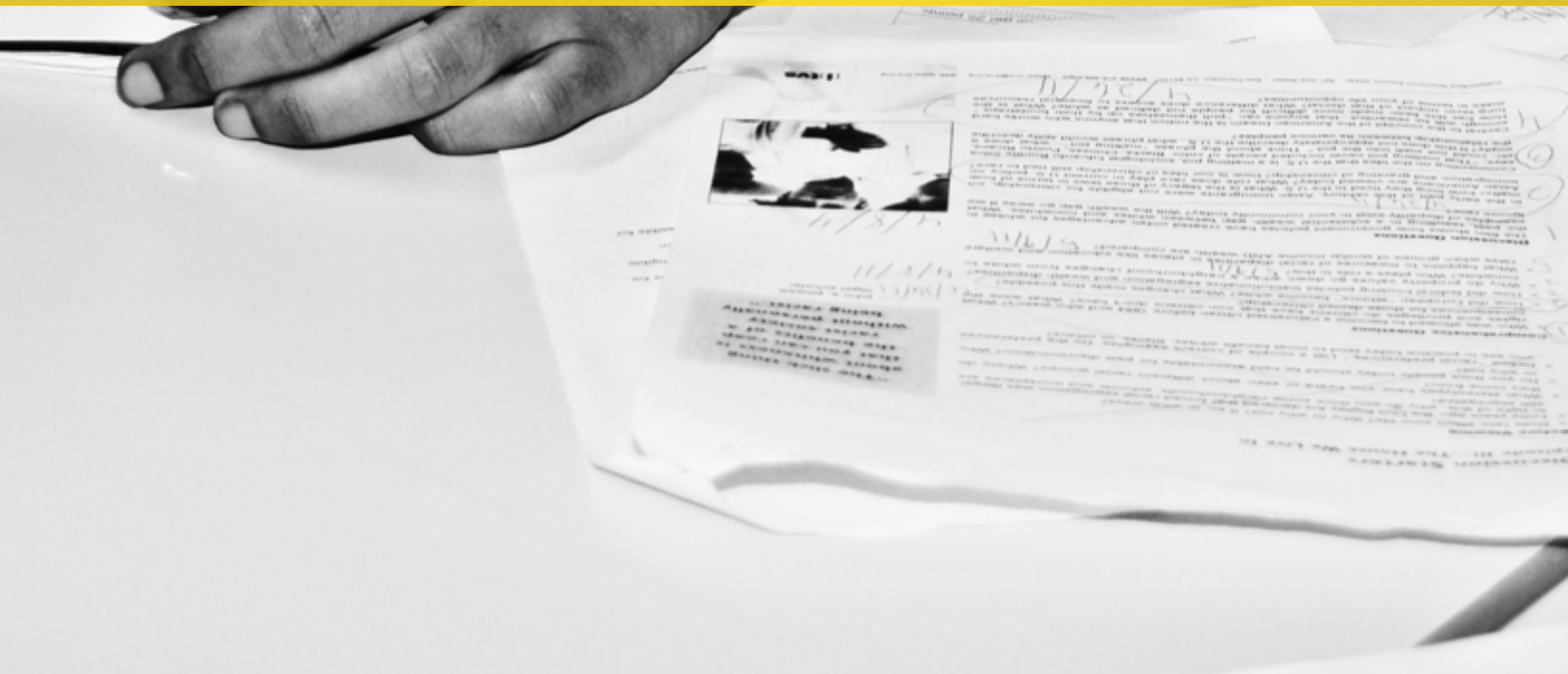
Learning takes place through the process of synthesizing real projects and mastering skills in an entrepreneurial environment.



Take the step

PROVIDE

If we do not start providing self-directed, alternative learning sites for students, neighborhoods will continue to deteriorate, students will not have access to the American dream, and dependency will continue to worsen as an epidemic in our country.



Essential Question



Do you believe that if we took students and built a site where they could explore, innovate, and create their own businesses prior to graduation, as well as implement a skill-based, critical thinking curriculum allowing them to be self-directed, they would be successful?

”

I have been to eight different schools and they tell us to change the community, but they don't show us or give us the tools to do it.

- Brianna

”

Good businesses support the education of the young, but our communities don't have those businesses and don't receive those resources.

- Javier

”

We want to have equal opportunity as those in Lincoln Park. We want better schools, better education and better health care.

- Erica

”

Most schools only teach you what they see, but the teachers don't see our world or what our communities can become.

- Brianne

META24 alters the current trend of traditional education and assists in revitalizing struggling communities.

Why META 24?

META24 is a true 21st century learning center with a unique instructional model and design.

APPROACH

Over the past two decades, our researchers, trainers, and reformers have worked with some of the most challenging students in the most extreme circumstances in urban areas such as Chicago, Milwaukee, Detroit, Baltimore, and Miami. They have had successes and failures in the different educational endeavors but one goal remained constant: doing right by the students.

Though policies and educational trends come and go, urban students still seek opportunities that will secure their futures, but most of the traditional schools are not providing these opportunities. In the past three years, Inquiry Bridge has been utilized in developing metacognitive and inquiry-based approaches to education in order to stimulate different outcomes for students. And while the progress and data is encouraging, it simply is not enough.

The sum of our experiences has led us to designing a learning space that will guide students in a new direction. While scores have increased, climates have improved, and students are earning degrees, we know that there is an urgency to develop specific 21st century skills in a practical manner sooner rather than later. This development is the principal goal of our new and innovative concept.

META24 is designed to attract students who have dropped out of school, failed to graduate, or are on track to graduate well below grade level. These students need to re-engage in learning, but because they often equate school with failure, they need a different kind of learning environment with an innovative and stimulating approach to curriculum.

META24 offers these unique students an innovative new learning environment. Students will master skills in active ways that challenge their abilities to think critically, problem-solve, and collaborate in a student-centered curriculum that includes essential, foundational skills, courses required for graduation credit, and challenging STEM-based subjects.

The **META24** environment incorporates the Inquiry Bridge curriculum to support students' endeavors to become lifelong learners as they grow in their competencies and become productive, employable 21st century citizens.

Focus Points

The sum of our experiences has led us to design a learning space that will guide students in new directions.

OPPORTUNITY

OPPORTUNITIES AND REQUIREMENTS

The U.S. Dept of Commerce shows that in the past ten years, STEM jobs grew 3 times the rate of non-STEM jobs, a trend likely to continue and accelerate.

The U.S. Dept of Labor notes that companies have reported more than 3 million job openings since February 2001 because of an absence of applicants with skills to fill these positions.

By the end of the decade, 60% of U.S. jobs are predicted to require some form of post-secondary education.

VALUE

VALUE OF POSTSECONDARY EDUCATION

Postsecondary education increases an individual student's chances for a decent, well-paying job. In terms of earnings, a holder of a bachelor's degree is likely to realize a million dollars more over a lifetime than an individual with only a high school diploma (Shierholtz et al., 2012).

SUCCESS

NEW PATHS TO SUCCESS

Three large, urban Midwestern school districts, Chicago, Milwaukee and Detroit claim a graduation rate of approximately 65%. Although this is somewhat higher than previous years, unfortunately, one out of every three students will drop out or fail to graduate. From these three districts, a total of 12,000 to 15,000 students leave high school each year with only a minimal level of employable skills.

In addition to those who have dropped out or failed to graduate, there are hundreds more who have received high school diplomas but will need to improve their foundational skills if they are to succeed in post secondary education and training. In 2014, the U.S. Dept of Labor estimated that the unemployment rate was 32% for out-of-school African American males ages 16 to 19.

META24 helps re-engage this population of dropouts, non-graduates, and those in need of improved basic skills in both their education and training. For the economic health of this country as well as for the futures these young people, many **META24** students will obtain dual enrollment in nearby Community Colleges furthering their college-ready capabilities while earning their high school diploma.

**METALABS**

MAKE - ENTERPRISE - TEACH - ACHIEVE

Make it count

GOALS

The objectives are for the students to analyze how to utilize the tools in each **METALAB** to experience economic growth within their school activities, use those skills to develop their own unique enterprises, and ultimately make those ideas materialize in their communities.

METALABS

METALABS are designed with the end product in mind to help students develop business acumen while being self directed by the inquiry model of skills-based learning.



SUCCEED

As an integral part of their studies, students work in labs to **MAKE** a useful, salable product. After learning how to write a business plan, students launch their new **ENTERPRISE**. As they work collaboratively, they **TEACH** each other essential skills which help them **ACHIEVE** positive results. As they experience success in their efforts, they reflect and focus on how they were able to succeed.

Metacognition builds confidence as students discover they have built new capabilities to help them succeed in future endeavors. Some of the products are sold directly in the school while other students use their services to help community businesses expand.



DRAFTING LAB

Auto Cad to Building Models



FINANCE LAB

Accounting, Billing, Market Research



CULTIVATION LAB

Aquaponics to Bioresearch



MEDIA PRODUCTION LAB

Video Marketing/Journalism/Shows



HI-TECH LAB

Coding to Robotics



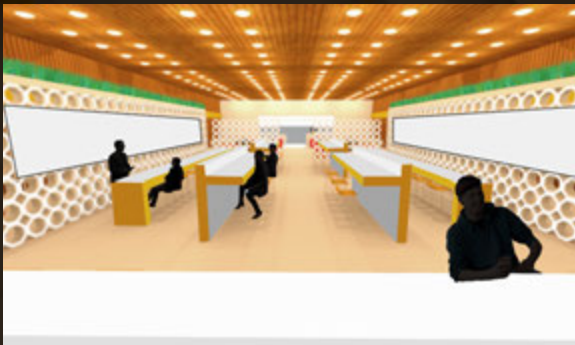
INDUSTRIAL DESIGN LAB

3D to Laser Printing



TRENDS LAB

Design Posters, Clothes, Booklets



GUIDE BAR

Guidance on Skill Based Mastery



THE BOARD ROOM

Students Work On Inquiry Bridge Game Board LMS



THE OFFICE

Executive Skills / Interviews



THE META CAFE

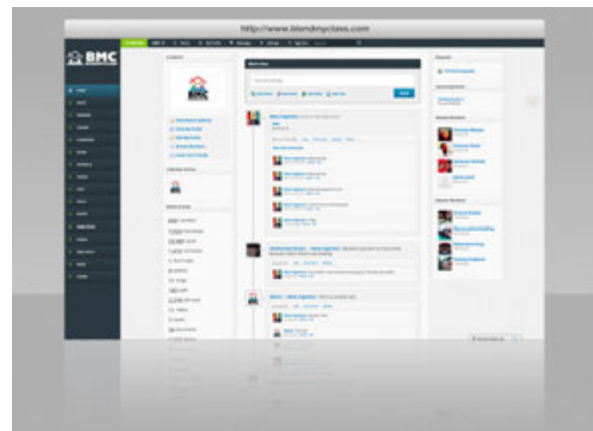
In-House, Student-Run Culinary Operation

Instructors

The role of the instructor is to help facilitate the synthesizing of the skills learned from the curriculum as well as the completion of the projects and the development of services created in the **METALABS**. Industry experts, KEY-STEAM coordinators, and the instructors collaborate in assisting the students work in the **METALABS**.

Curriculum: 24

META24's overarching goal is to promote the use of higher level thinking skills as students master both foundational and challenging skills.



META-COGNITION

The use of higher-level thinking skills provides development and practice in problem-solving and leads to metacognition. Students not only know what they have learned but know how they have learned it.

The underlying framework for this form of studying is the Inquiry Bridge curriculum model. It serves as a roadmap for both teachers and students as they move together through 24 separate but interrelated skill clusters. As they proceed, a colorful, computerized Success Board plots individual student progress which aids students in monitoring and reinforcing their progress. The continuously updated Success Board also helps instructors monitor students' responses in order to provide timely feedback.

Learning Management System

LMS

Student data is collected on the Success Board and is displayed through a Learning Management System (LMS). While many learning management systems collect data and provide instructional links to lesson plans, the LMS used in the **METALAB** is much more robust. This LMS provides four separate but interconnected sections.

The LMS provides parents with information pertaining to the assignments and progress of their students. It also provides information about community projects, especially those in which students and members of the community work collaboratively.

The LMS provides professional development for teachers to reinforce their teaching techniques, especially in differentiating instruction while maximizing the impact of inquiry-based instruction.

The LMS provides the students a section with a comprehensive combination of lessons, reviews, placement assessments, practice quizzes, and mastery tests. Students interact daily with the LMS to keep track of their assignments, practice skills, review steps, watch instructional videos, and take their unit assessments. Students also access the LMS to post learning blogs and monitor their progress throughout the units.

PROGRESS MONITORING

Teachers access the LMS to monitor student progress and plan instructional interventions when necessary. Teachers and administrators are able to aggregate data in the LMS to evaluate the overall progress being achieved within the Inquiry Bridge curriculum by grade level, content subject, and schoolwide filters.

The Learning Management System is developed to incorporate essential features required to advance students at an accelerated rate. Synthesized standards assist students by filling in the gaps so that they may be successful in competently completing the most challenging coursework which ultimately develops their higher-level thinking skills. Additionally, students' confidence and knowledge base are increased as newly acquired learning strategies are developed and honed through repeated practice and increased difficulty.

Results & Impact

What our teachers see in our students.

When students build an URBAN GARDEN, we see GROWTH in INNOVATIVENESS, ACCOUNTABILITY, and RESPONSIBILITY.

When students learn in INQUIRY BRIDGE'S SKILLS-BASED MODEL, we see INCREASES in EFFORT, ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE, and GRADUATION RATES.

When students use the BLENDMYCLASS LEARNING MANAGEMENT SYSTEM, we see improvement in ORGANIZATIONAL SKILLS, PRIDE, and PROACTIVENESS.

When students are able to choose their EDUCATIONAL PATHS, we see RISES in CONTENTMENT, CONFIDENCE, and AWARENESS: cultural, political, and self.

When students utilize the STEM LABS, we see GAINS in COMMITMENT, INDEPENDENT LEARNING, and CRITICAL THINKING.

When students start their own BUSINESSES, we see ADVANCEMENT in ENTREPRENEURIAL SKILLS, RELEVANT LEARNING, and RELATIONAL TRUST.

Get started today

META24: A True Public-Private Partnership.

MAKE IT HAPPEN

META24 learning centers educate public school students. The centers are funded through a variety of methods including district-paid tuition, state aid/grants, federal aid/grants, private foundations and individual philanthropists. Although educating public school students often with public funds, **META24** centers are privately run by the META division of Banner Learning Corp, a nonprofit 501(c)(3) organization.

Being operated by a private nonprofit organization results in greater freedom to implement our innovative and highly effective educational methods. These methods often lead to significantly greater success among students. At the same time, we operate the learning centers in conformance with any applicable district, state, and federal education standards. Moreover, we work closely with district personnel to address any specific requests and are able to adapt as necessary. The flexibility of **META24** centers makes it fit within any urban school district.

Start at

www.meta24.org